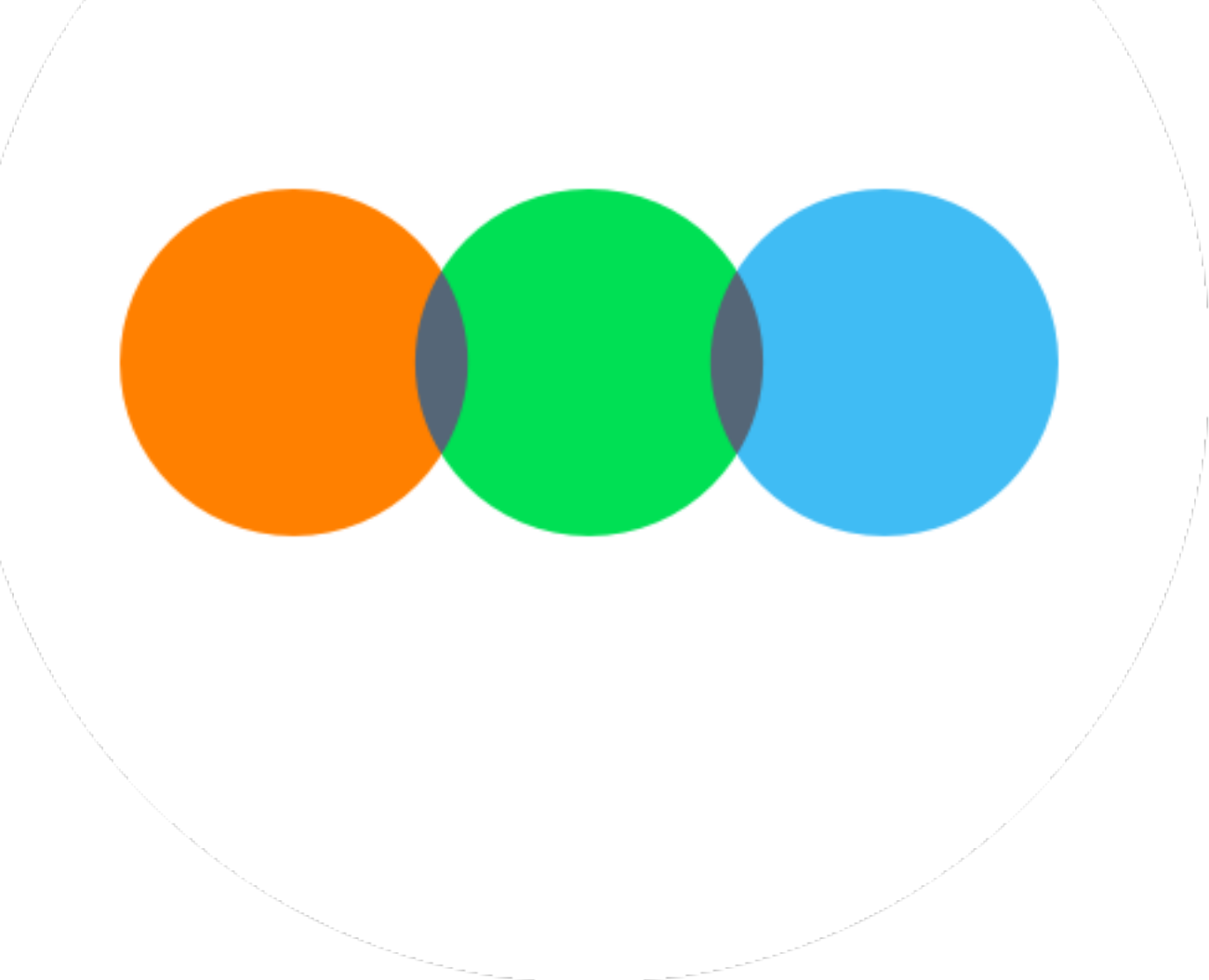
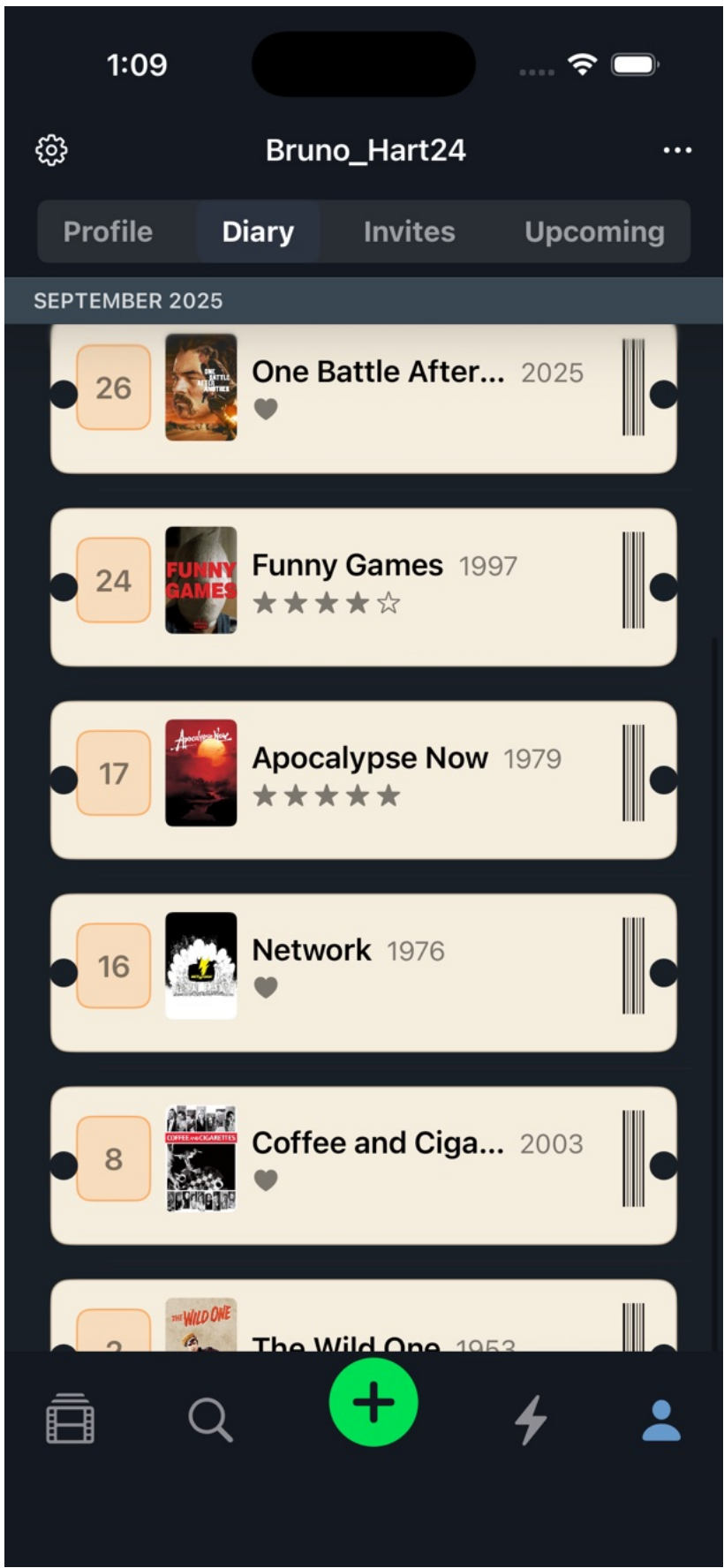
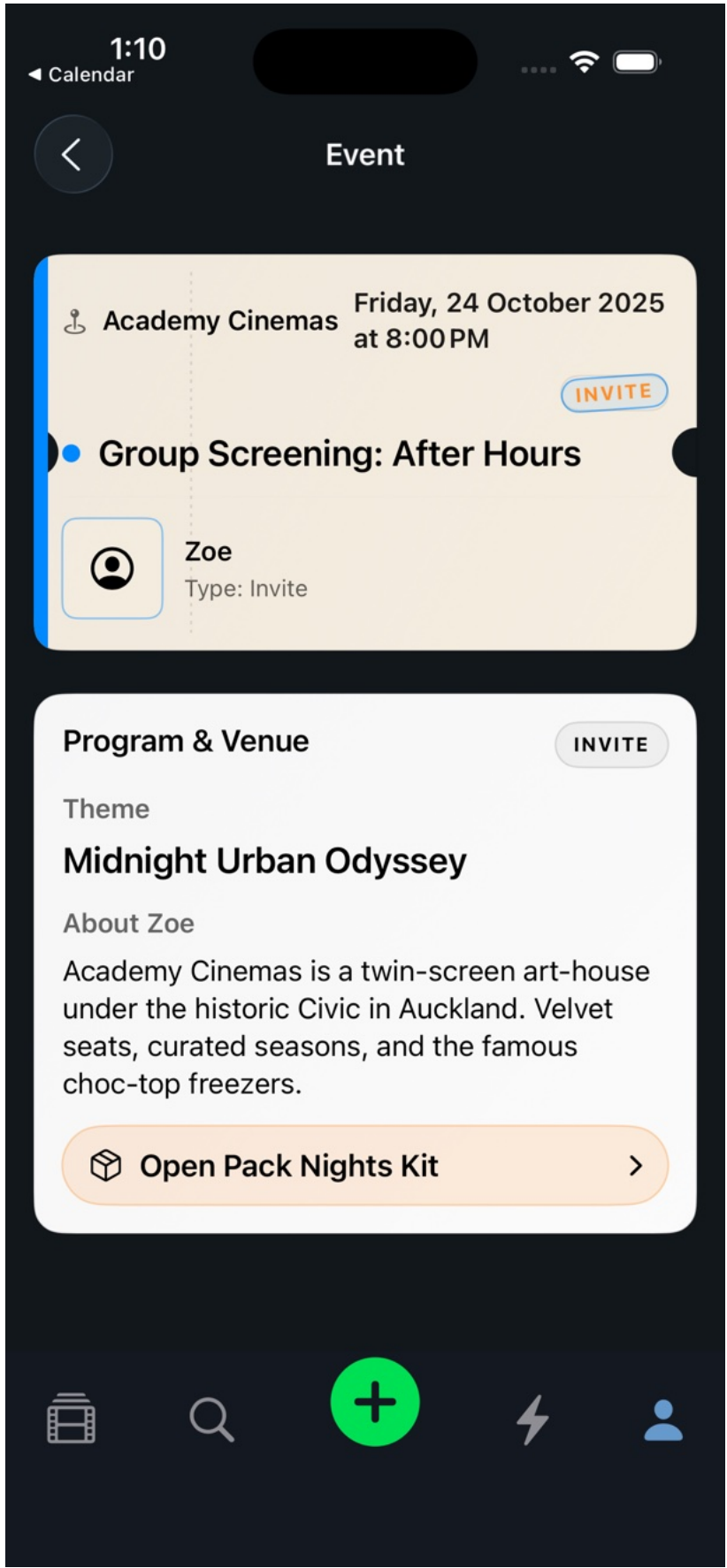
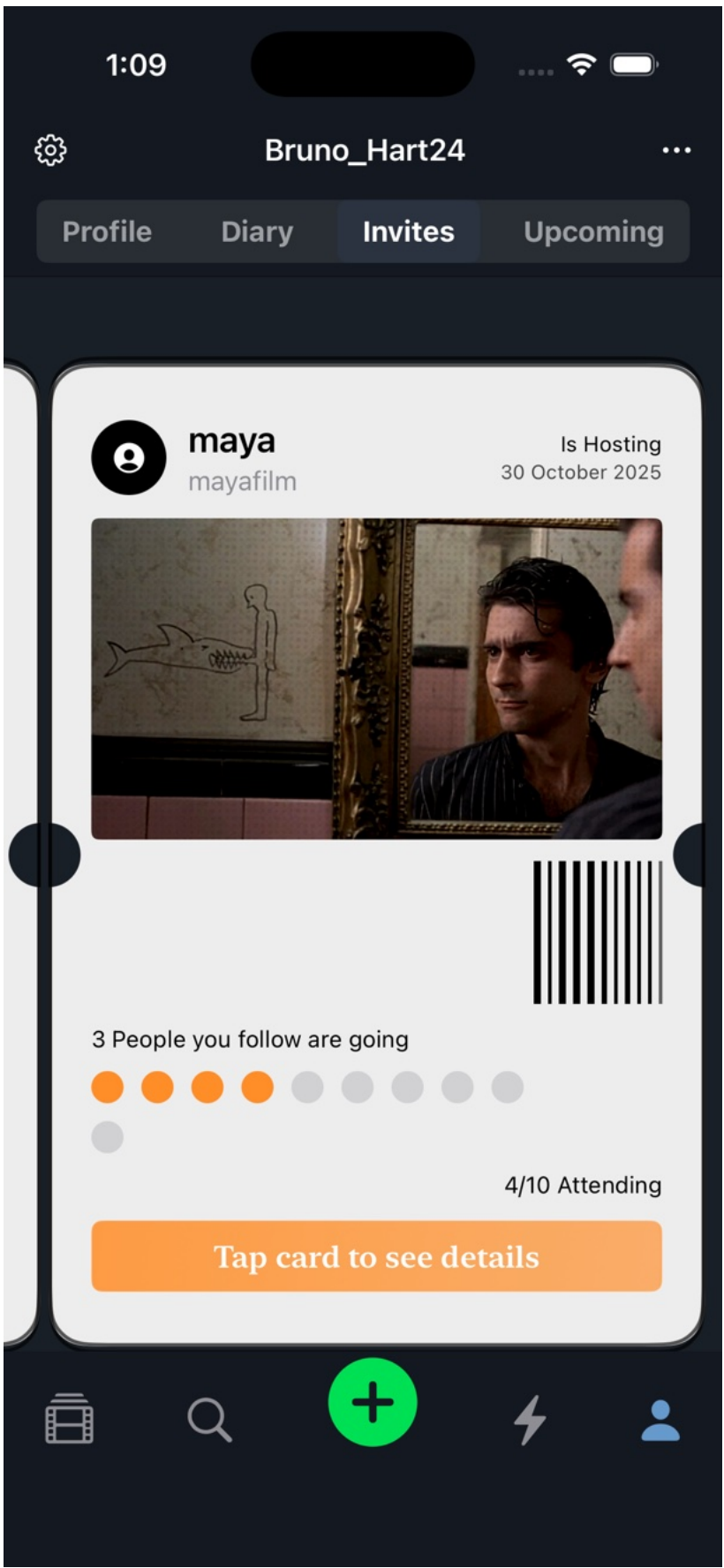
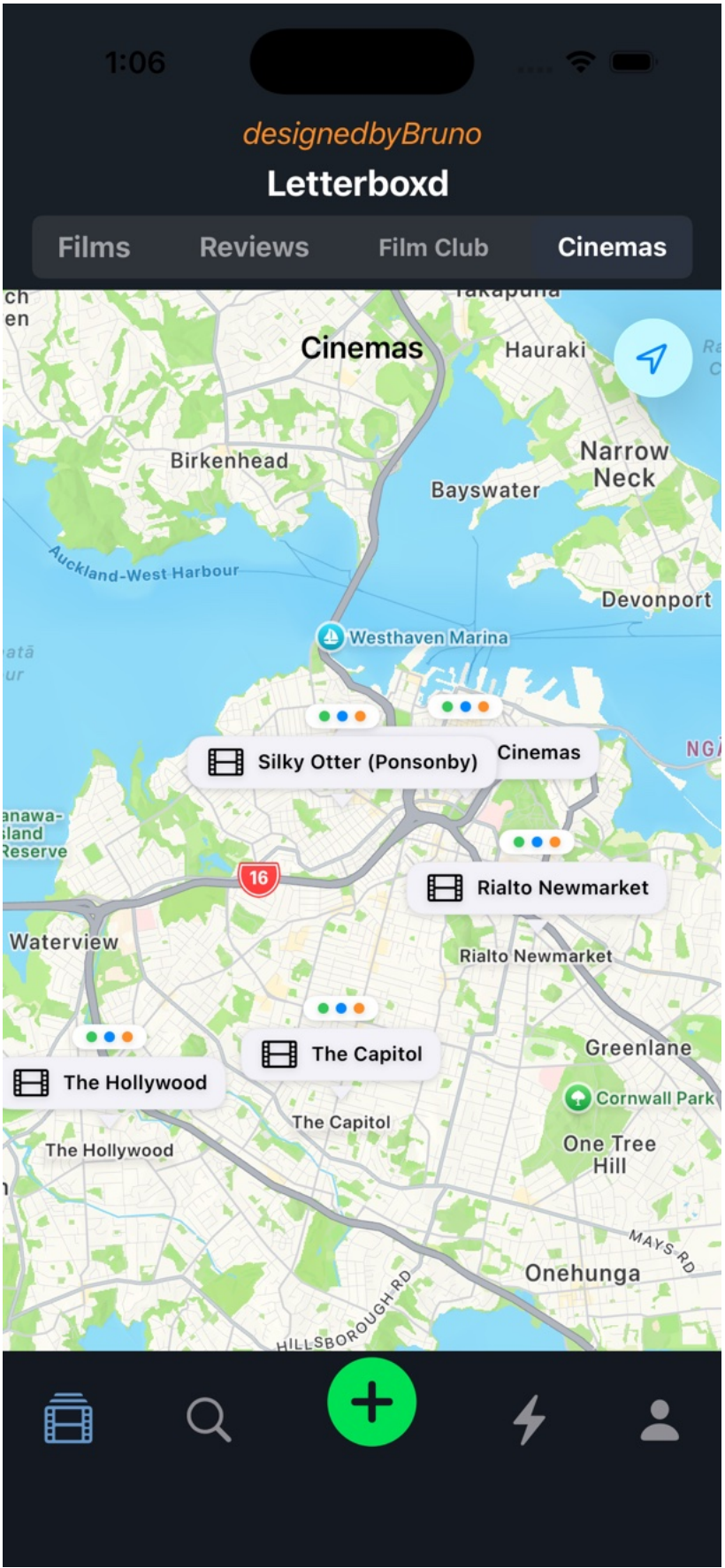
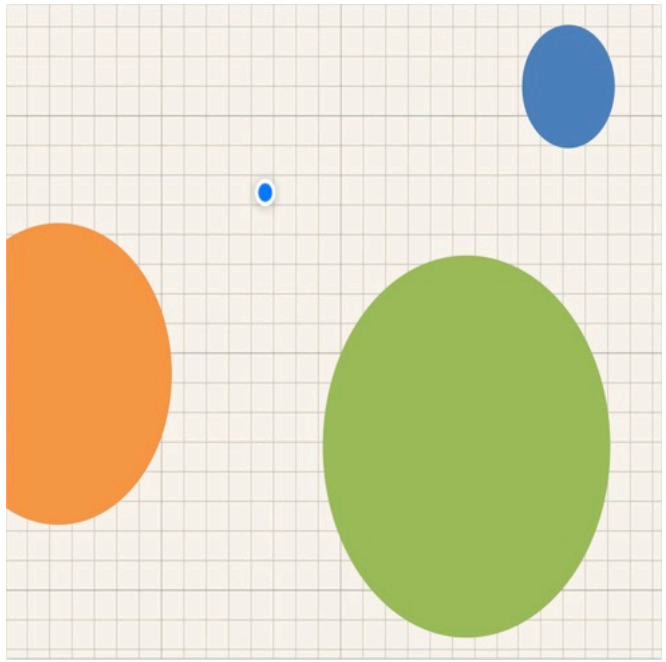
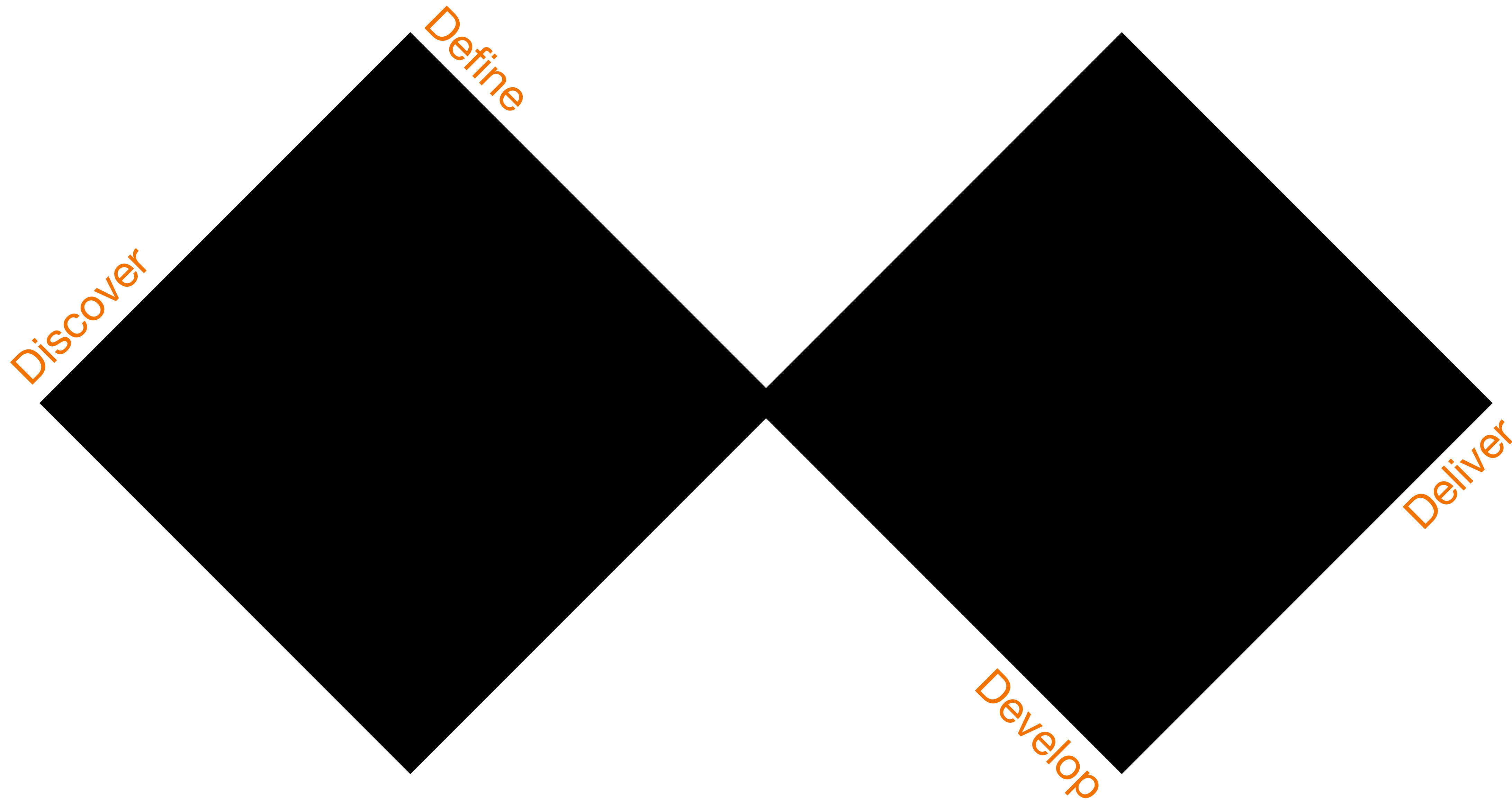


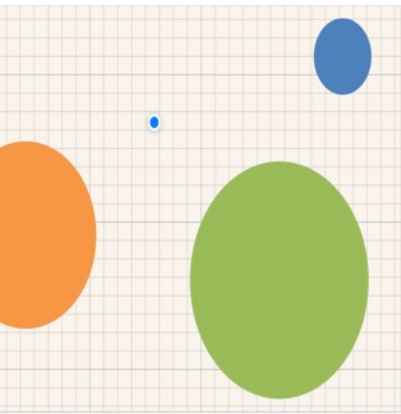
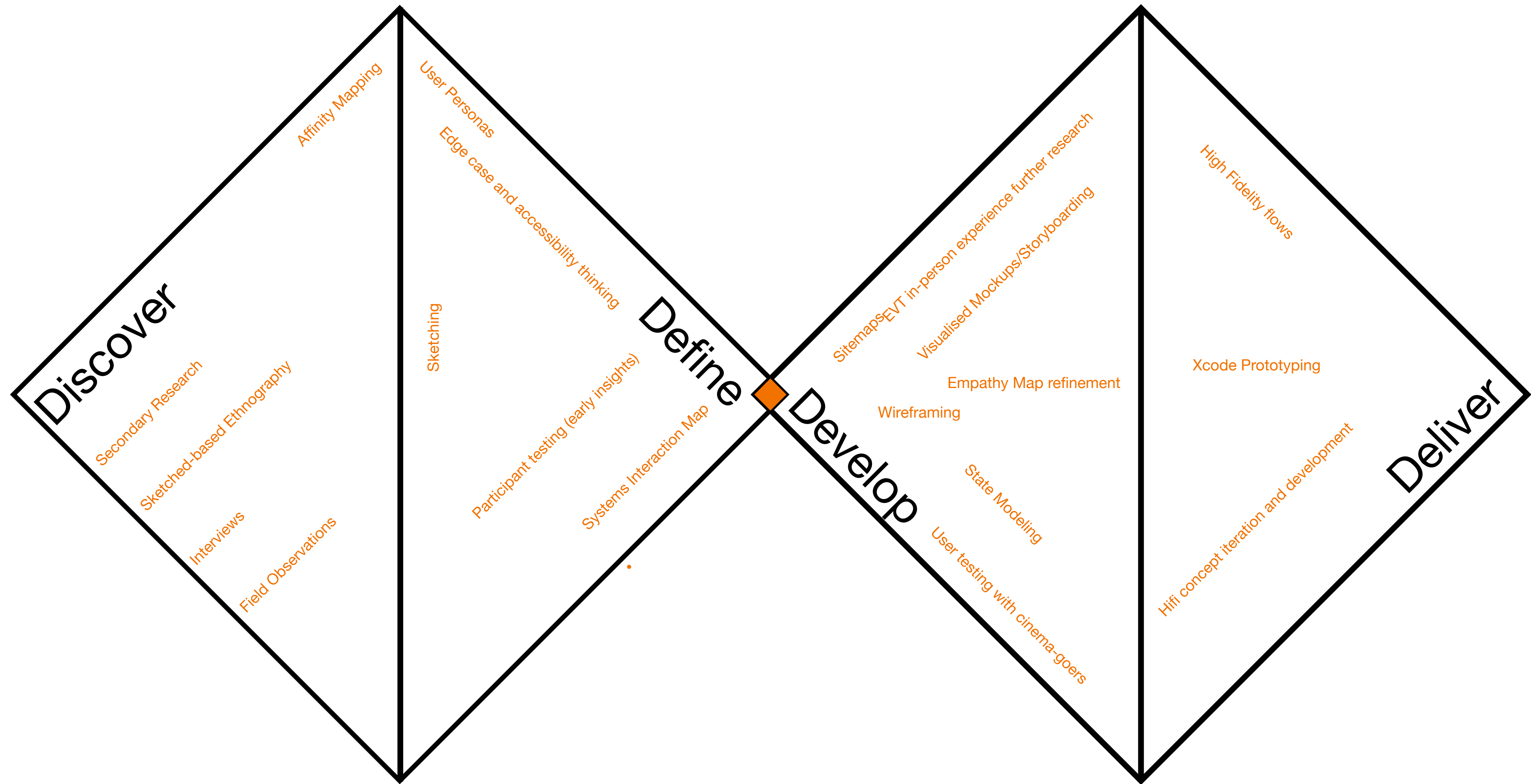


"One of the ways that I believe people express their appreciation to the rest of humanity is to make something wonderful and put it out there".

Steve Jobs circa 2007 in an internal mail sent to Apple Senior Design Executives

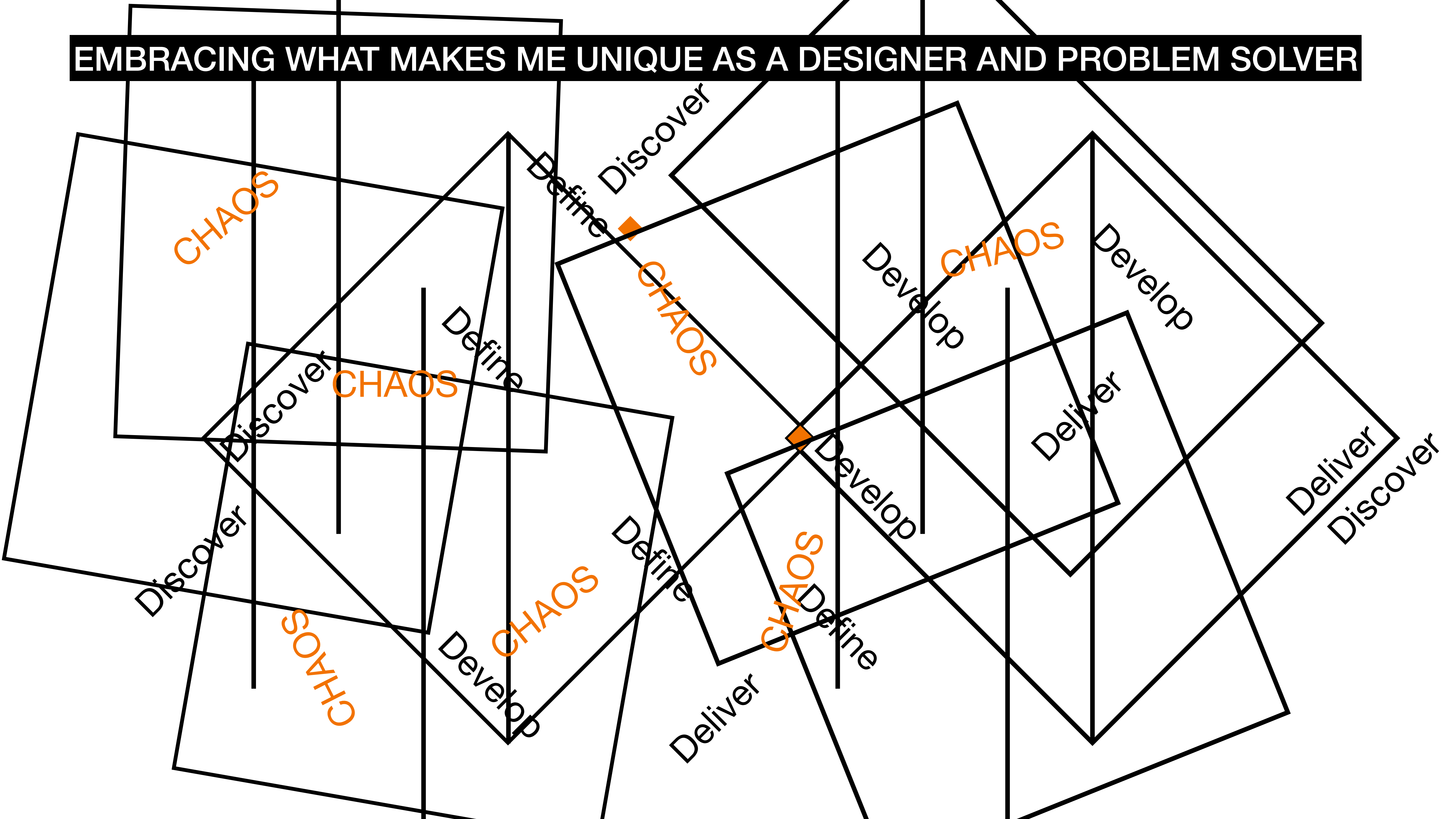






Letterboxd
designedbyBruno

EMBRACING WHAT MAKES ME UNIQUE AS A DESIGNER AND PROBLEM SOLVER



KIWI COMPANY = FOCUS ON AOTEAROA CONTEXT

Overview to the topic

This project set out to rekindle the emotional ritual of moviegoing by following a human-centred UX process to bridge in-theatre moments with the reflective ecosystem of Letterboxd. To ground the design, I combined primary research field sketches, rapid ethnography as well as secondary research academic literature, industry journalism, and podcast discourse to surface the psychological, social, and business factors shaping contemporary cinephile behaviour and community building.

The next stages were about **developing, iterating, and crafting design solutions** that could meaningfully translate these insights into lived, interactive experiences. Each design phase moved the project closer to a system that didn't just *represent* cinema culture but actively *revived* it.

Through cycles of sketching, prototyping, and user testing, the project evolved from conceptual mappings into a tangible, emotionally resonant prototype. The process became a continual dialogue between research and making — testing how tactility, reflection, and digital craft could coexist to serve the brief's human-centred aims.

Design Vision

TAKEN DIRECTLY FROM ASSIGNMENT 1's BRIEF

"Make cinema feel personal again."

Inspired by the emotional tactility of vintage ticketing, the ritual of commitment (calendar adds), and the social reinforcement of shared taste, this project aims to create a system where digital actions lead to real-life meaning and vice versa.

This project positions Letterbox not just as a film log, but as the Strava for cinema: an app that builds cultural identity, community belonging, and third-place activity through experiential UX

I began with my vision for the future



How can I get the most out of the Capstone to develop my design voice and vision??

Discover

I began with my vision for the future



A24



Define



How can I get here or here or at least continue developing on my journey towards changing the world??

Develop

Deliver

Empathic Foundations

Affinity mapping and empathy mapping distilled these behaviours into user needs:

- Immediate but low-stakes ways to capture post-film emotion,
- Physical anchors that extend the sensory memory of cinema,
- Social features that feel intimate, not performative.

The user personas—developed from assignment one insights and refined through testing feedback—anchored decisions in lived perspectives, ensuring features like invites, loyalty artifacts, and reflective spaces resonated with distinct user needs while still serving the holistic ecosystem.

Ben Romero emerged from the insight that many cinephiles long for cinema as an aesthetic ritual rather than a transactional experience. His goals ("to direct films that feel like dreams") and pain points (academic film culture being "too dry," longing for more physical engagement) gave rise to design decisions like the reflective diary window, tactile loyalty artifacts, and analogue-inspired invites. User testing reinforced these needs, validating that features like collectible stubs and quiet mode directly answered his desire to "capture the emotional residue of a screening."

"I don't just want to make movies. I want to make people feel like they're dreaming with their eyes open."

Profile Overview

- **Name:** Ben Romero
- **Age:** 22
- **Pronouns:** he/him
- **Location:** Auckland, NZ
- **Occupation:** Final-year student, double major in Film & Graphic Design
- **Personality Type:** INFJ — visionary, idealistic, detail-oriented
- **Letterboxd Top 4:**
 - 8½
 - Her
 - The Double Life of Veronique
 - La Haine

Design + Tech Life

- Uses **Figma**, **InDesign**, and **DaVinci Resolve** daily.
- Designs posters, stickers, and physical props for short films.
- Keeps a personal **film journal**, often writing on napkins, postcards, ticket stubs.
- Obsessed with **criterion packaging** and tactile media design.
- Uses **Letterboxd**, but in a whisper, not a shout.

Goals & Dreams

- To **direct films that feel like dreams** — moody, emotional, layered.
- To one day screen his debut feature at a small cinema like the ones he loves.
- To **build an aesthetic language** that blends graphic design with personal filmmaking.
- To be part of a film community that values poetic over prestige.

Pain Points

- Finds most academic film work **too dry**, missing the soul of cinema.
- Longs for **more physical engagement** with the filmmaking process such as tickets, zines, notebooks.
- Wishes there were better ways to **capture the emotional residue** of a screening.
- Finds digital spaces overwhelming and too performative — he often **logs films privately** and writes poetic fragments instead of reviews.

SAYS

'I don't want to log something too soon—it won't be honest.'

'I forget what I felt by the time I'm home.'

'I'd rather go with people than go alone.'

'I feel like a film person when I go to the cinema.'

'There's just too many options sometimes—it's overwhelming.'

Thinks Letterboxd is more of a record than an experience.

Thinks the app doesn't connect with the cinematic experience.

THINKS

FEELS

Wants curated suggestions, not infinite feeds.

Nostalgic when they see film stubs or invites.

Excited when a friend sends them a cinema invite.

Disengaged when logging feels like work.

Goes with one or two people, not big groups.

Sometimes forgets to log films altogether.

Avoids opening the app right after the screening.

Trusts local venues to offer something special.

DOES

Cinephile Composite

NEEDS / GOALS

- To ritualize cinema-going in a way that feels personal, reflective, and communal.
- To make reflection immediate, tactile, and embodied (diary windows, doodles, stubs).
- To feel invited into cinema culture through personalized, aesthetic entry points.
- To see venues play an active role in enhancing the cinematic ritual.
- To maintain intimacy (smaller groups, private fragments) while still feeling connected to a larger community.

PAIN POINTS

- Traditional logging feels too delayed, performative, or like work.
- Event listings are sterile, lack tactility or anticipation.
- Fragmentation across apps for booking, planning, reflecting is frustrating.
- Loyalty systems that feel gamified or transactional don't resonate.
- Fear of missing the emotional moment if reflection is pushed too late.

Zoe Akhtar drew from the insight that the journey is fractured across platforms. Her persona as a community manager with a reflective, INFP disposition highlighted the need for tools that unify discovery, planning, and reflection. Her descriptors (valuing cinema as identity, logging as self-record, and wanting connection) translated into design flows like RSVP + calendar integration, film club invites, and map-based discovery. Testing feedback about invites feeling "personal" and the map feeling like a "treasure map" deepened her persona, giving weight to decisions around how these features were visually and interactively framed.

"Movies make me feel seen — that's why I log everything. Not for the likes, but to build a record of how I've changed."

Profile Overview

- **Name:** Zoe Akhtar
- **Age:** 24
- **Pronouns:** she/her
- **Location:** Wellington, NZ
- **Occupation:** Social Media & Community Manager, Lightbox Cinema (a boutique indie cinema chain)
- **Education:** Bachelor of Fine Arts in Media & Communication
- **Personality Type:** INFP — sensitive, introspective, emotionally articulate
- **Film Taste:**
 - Letterboxd Top 4:
 - The Worst Person in the World
 - Before Sunrise

Goals & Motivations

- To **cultivate emotional memory** through film — Letterboxd is her diary, not her portfolio.
- To help her audience at the cinema feel **connected, seen, and invited to reflect**.
- To foster a **slow media culture** that resists passive consumption.

Pain Points

- Feels a disconnect between the magic of seeing a film and the sterile process of logging it hours (or days) later.
- Struggles to make *Lightbox's* content on social media feel as **intimate** as the screenings themselves.
- Wishes there were better tools for encouraging **audience reflection** in real time — not just star ratings or hashtags.
- Finds that many cinema-goers don't have a habit of **sharing their emotional reactions**, even when deeply moved.

Behavior & Beliefs

- Logs every film with a short, honest reflection — often emotional, sometimes cryptic, always sincere.
- Believes **design should feel lived in**, not clinical — she loves tactile interfaces and zine-style assets.
- Advocates for **quiet UX** that enhances space rather than intrudes upon it.
- Drawn to moments where **theater and community overlap**: Q&As, zine drops, moody installations.

Tech + Tools

- **Letterboxd Pro** (obviously) — she has an emotional tagging system for moods.
- **Instagram + Threads** — she runs Lightbox's online presence with a mix of moody stills, reels, and poetic captions.
- **Pinterest** — for visual world-building, personal **moodboards**, and campaign ideas.
- **Film Cameras** — shoots rolls of film

FOCUS ON THE CORE LETTERBOXD USERBASE



Core Problem

Letterboxd is one of the most culturally valuable film platforms in the world — a space where people log, rate, and reflect on what they've watched.

But despite its deep emotional and social potential, it exists after the cinematic moment.

There's a major gap between the act of going to the movies and the act of recording that experience.

While streaming platforms have integrated frictionless watching and sharing, the in-person film ritual — buying tickets, attending screenings, reflecting with friends — remains disconnected from the digital ecosystem.

As a result:

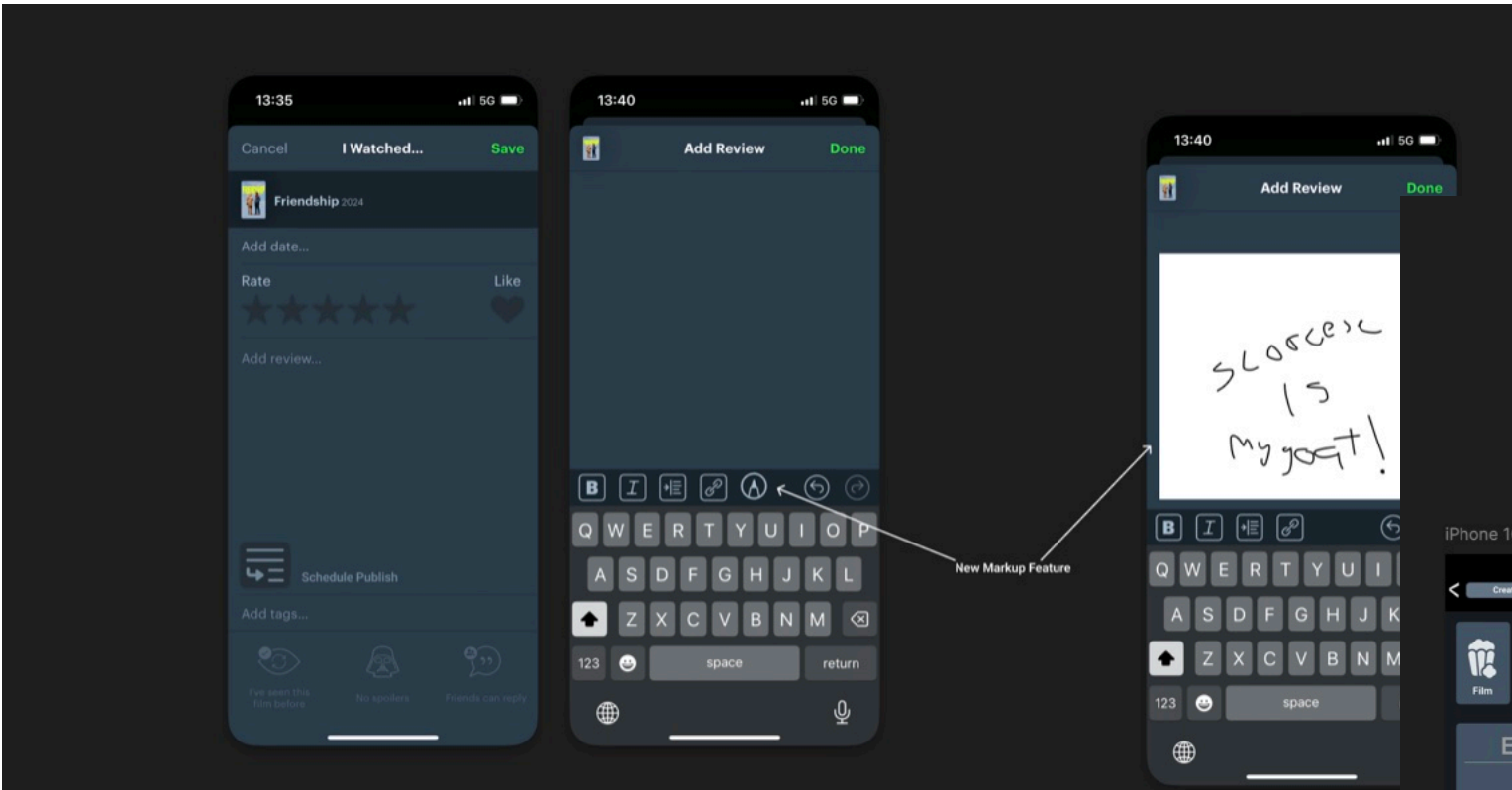
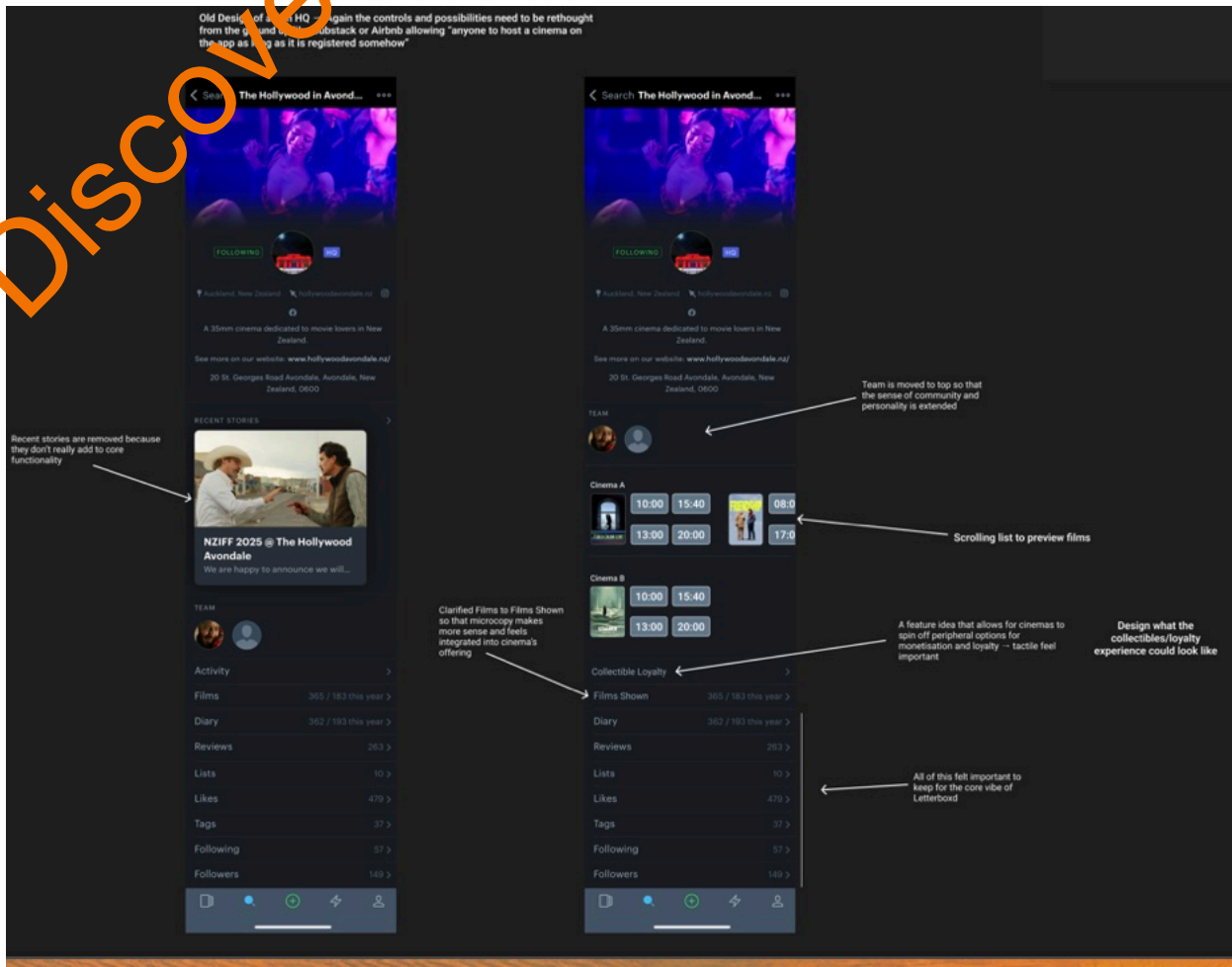
- The platform misses the opportunity to shape real-world cinema behavior.
- Cinemas lose engagement from Letterboxd's passionate, data-rich community.
- Audiences experience reflection and discovery as separate, not continuous.



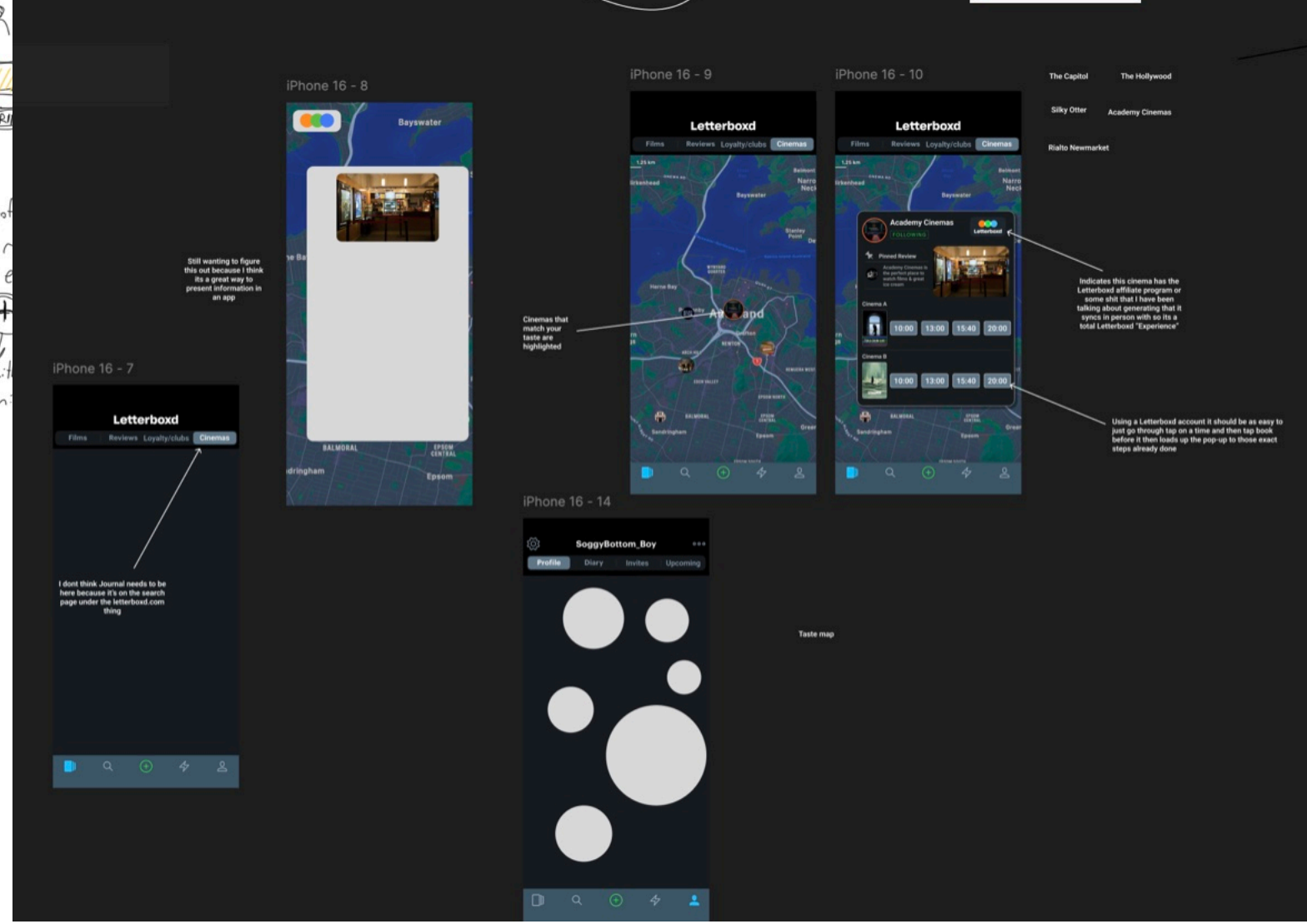
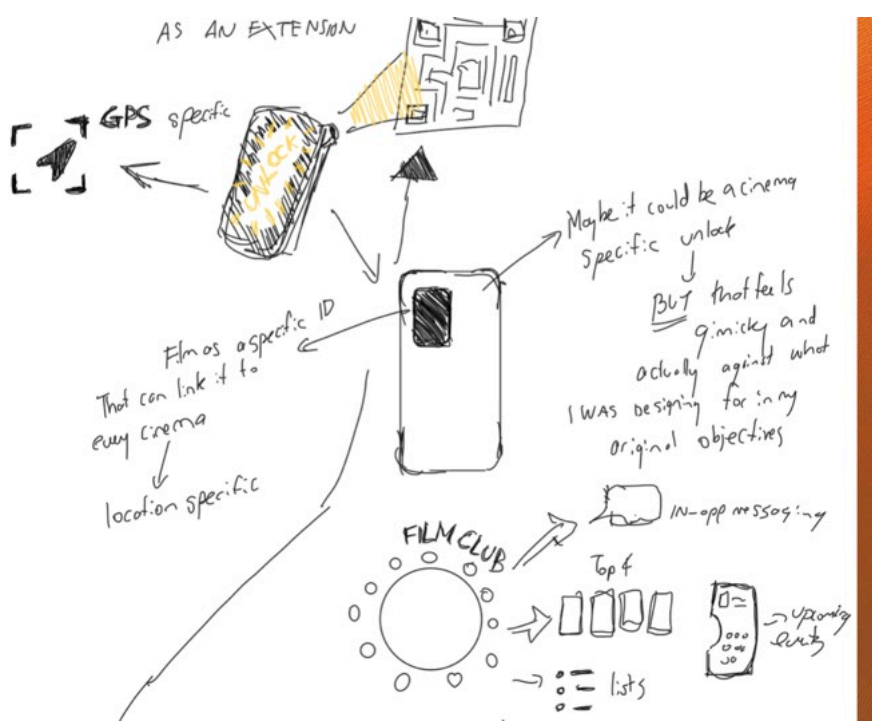
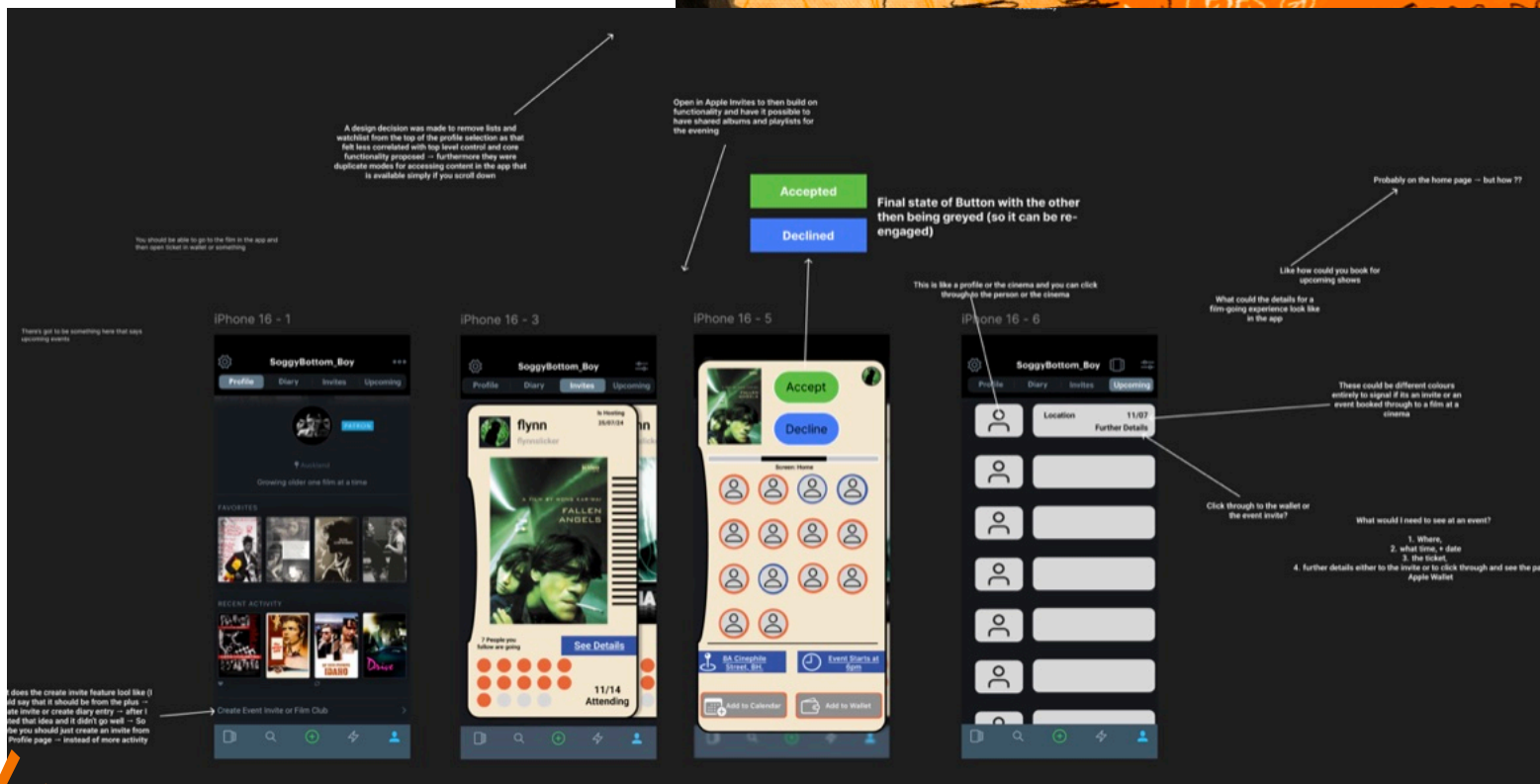
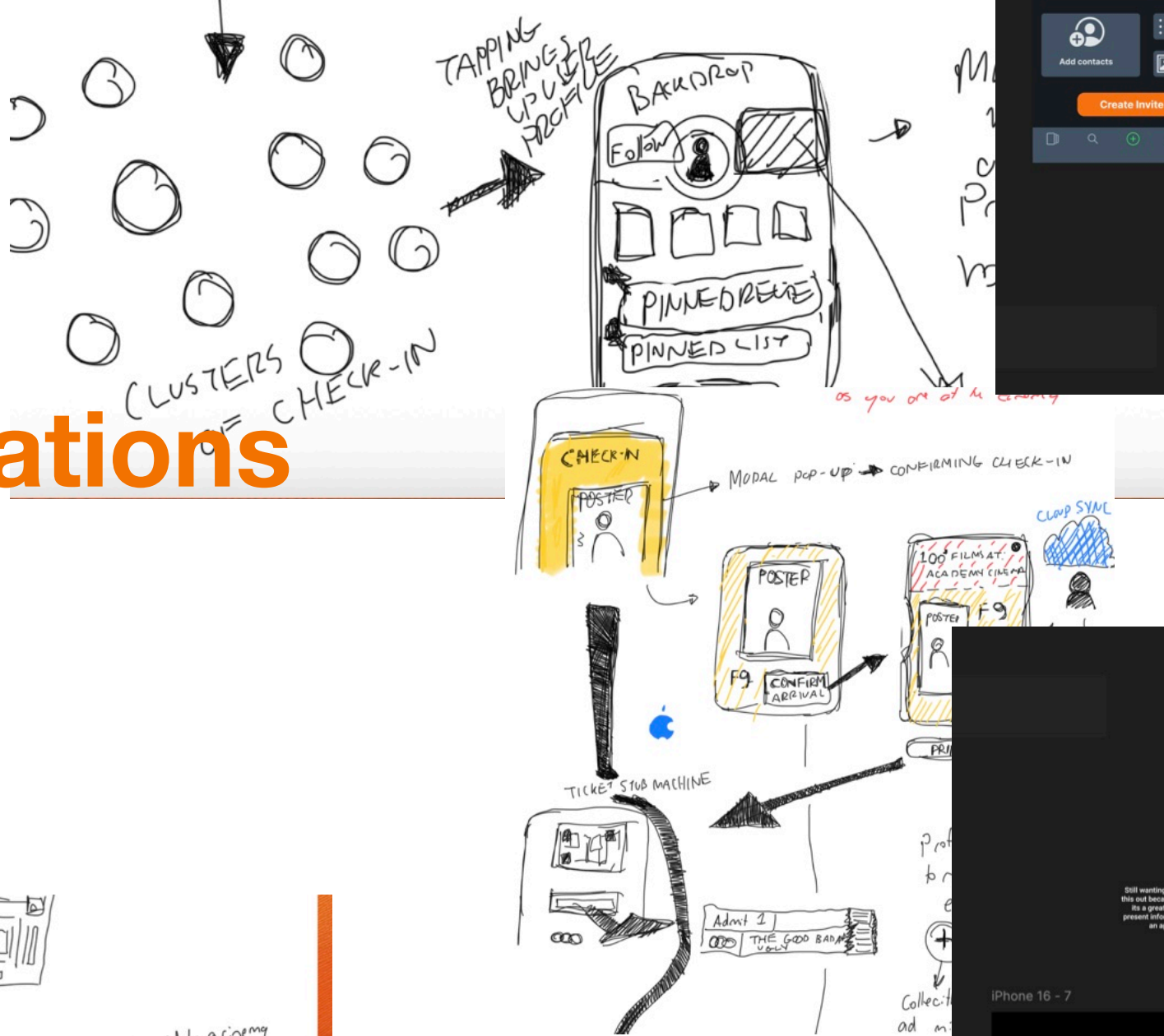
My core objectives from the brief restated

- Create a set of 3-5 tools/features that enhance the emotional and social potential of attending a film screening.
- Design a prototype that aligns with analog values → simplicity, tactility, reflection.
- Deliver a concept that can be adopted by independent cinemas and film festivals to raise audience engagement and brand value.
- Build Visual Skills and Prototyping Skills for Design of Digital Products and Physical Space Nuanced understanding (multi-variant) of the problem space as a bridge between personal and communal as well digital and physical
- Demonstrate how design can serve slowness, not just speed → friction as a function not a flaw.

Define



Lofi-Skecthes and design experimentations



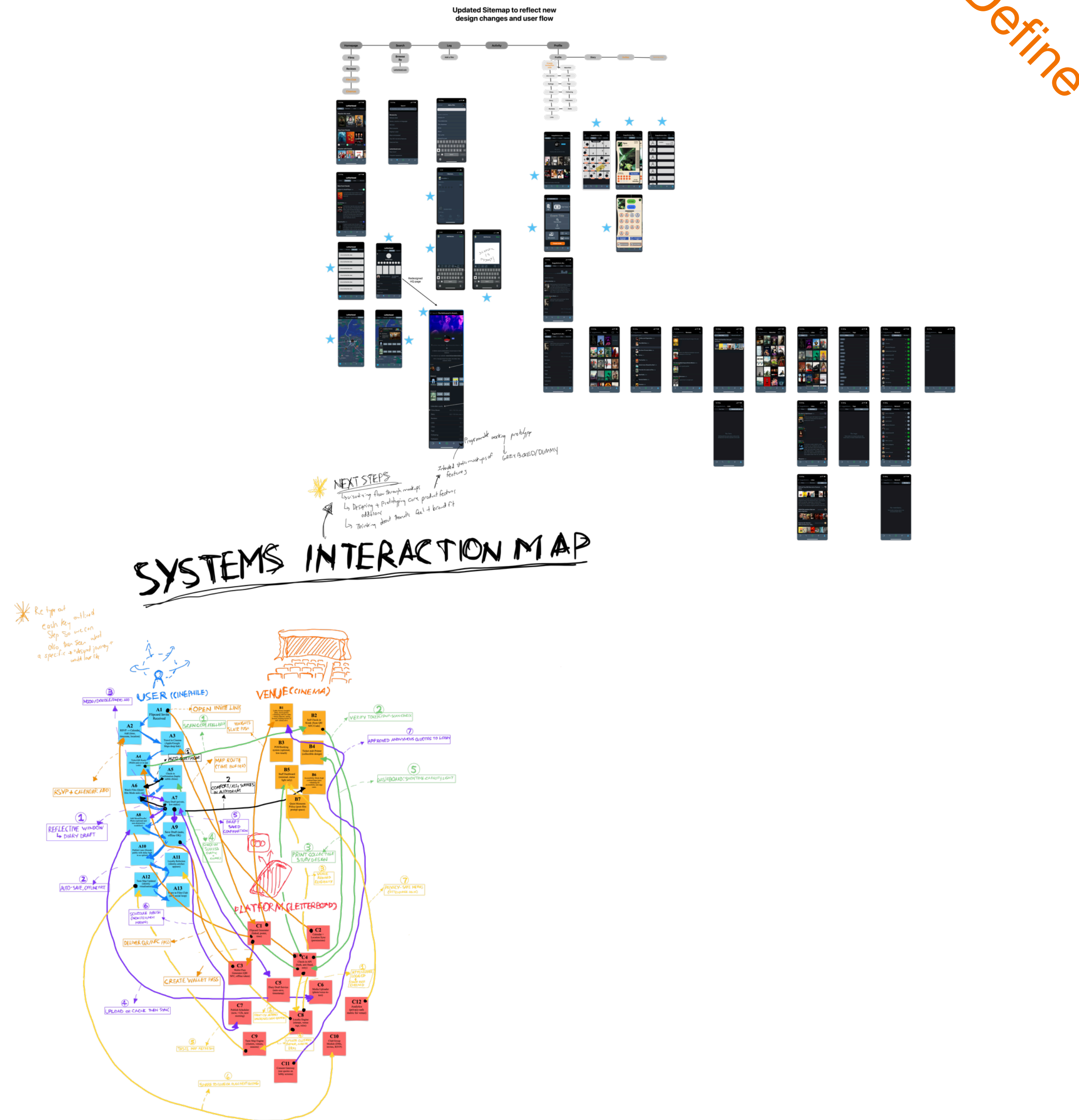
What I Did

To address the design brief, I conceived, designed, and built a suite of new features and tools that extend Letterboxd's ecosystem while preserving its core identity.

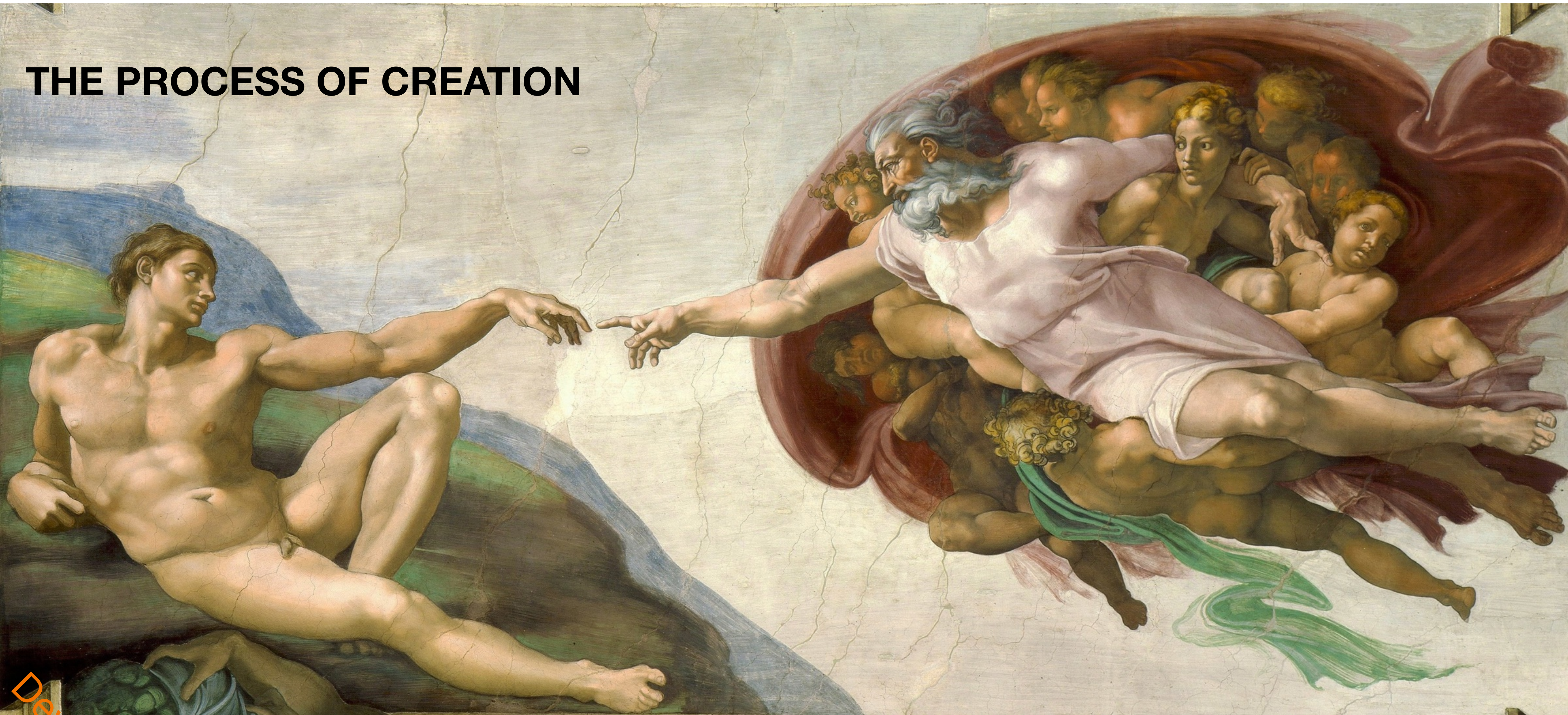
Key Features and Innovations

1. Film Club – A new social space for organizing and participating in collective film experiences.
2. Create Event / Invites – A tactile invitation system for hosting screenings with cinematic flair.
3. Cinema Map – A live, location-based map integrating local cinemas into the Letterboxd experience.
4. Redesigned Booking Flows – Streamlined ticket purchasing and in-app booking for seamless usability.
5. Calendar & Planning Integration – EventKit-powered scheduling and reminders for screenings and meetups.
6. Wallet & Payment Integration – Apple Wallet-ready passes and direct payment support for events.
7. Multi-Modal Experience Design – Reimagined Letterboxd as an operating-system-like companion embedded in daily, spatial routines.
8. Physical & Digital Collectible Tokens – One-of-one digital and tangible keepsakes with custom-coded logic.
9. Tactile Vintage Design Language – A cohesive visual and interaction system that deepens Letterboxd's UI through analog texture, craft, and care.
10. Pack Nights – A sensory, group-focused experience layer designed to elevate at-home and in-cinema film nights.
11. Invite Craftsmanship – Immersive, duotone-styled invite designs featuring micro-interactions like “flick on tap.”
12. TMDb API Integration – Live film data fetching for posters and backdrops, dynamically populating invites, stubs, and event pages.

To implement these features, I undertook extensive systems thinking and interaction mapping to identify where each new function could integrate naturally into the existing Letterboxd architecture — enhancing the user experience without disrupting its established flow or brand integrity.



THE PROCESS OF CREATION



THE PROCESS OF CREATION

[illegible]

THE PROCESS OF CREATION

Develop

Visual & Motion System

Core Palette:

- lbSurface (deep black-green), lbCard (charcoal film stock), Letterboxd green accents.
- Duotone overlays for posters (cream/amber; rust/teal) to suggest vintage print.

Typography:

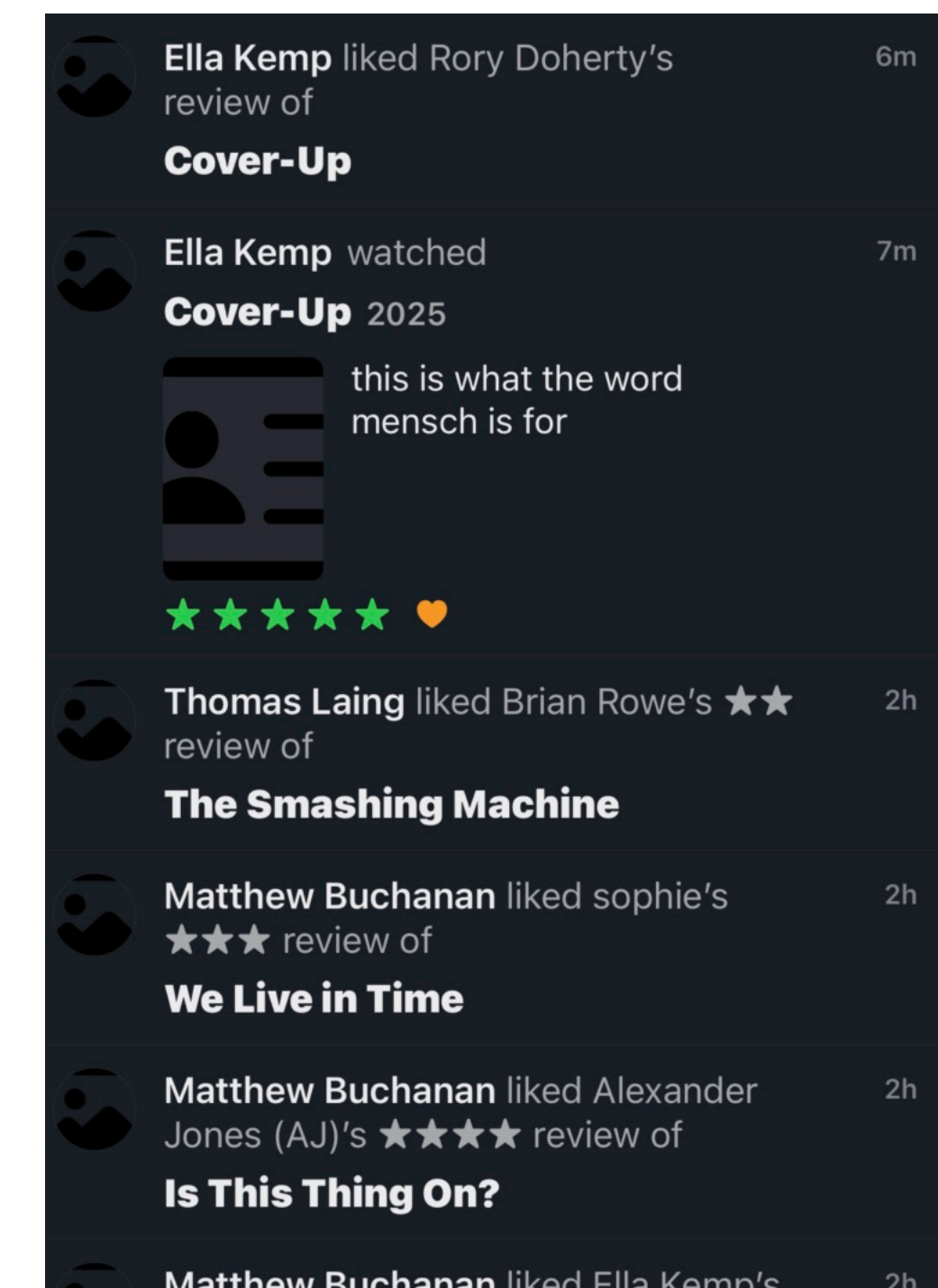
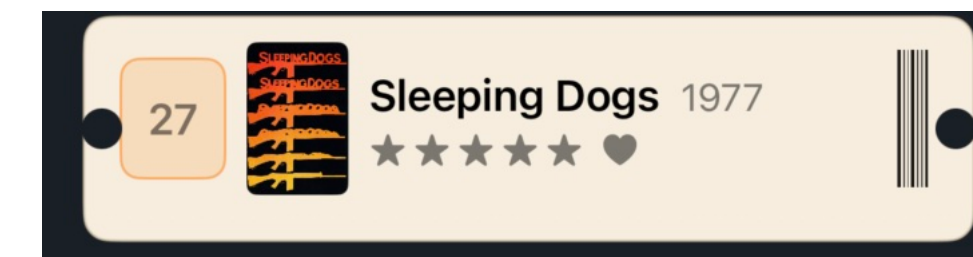
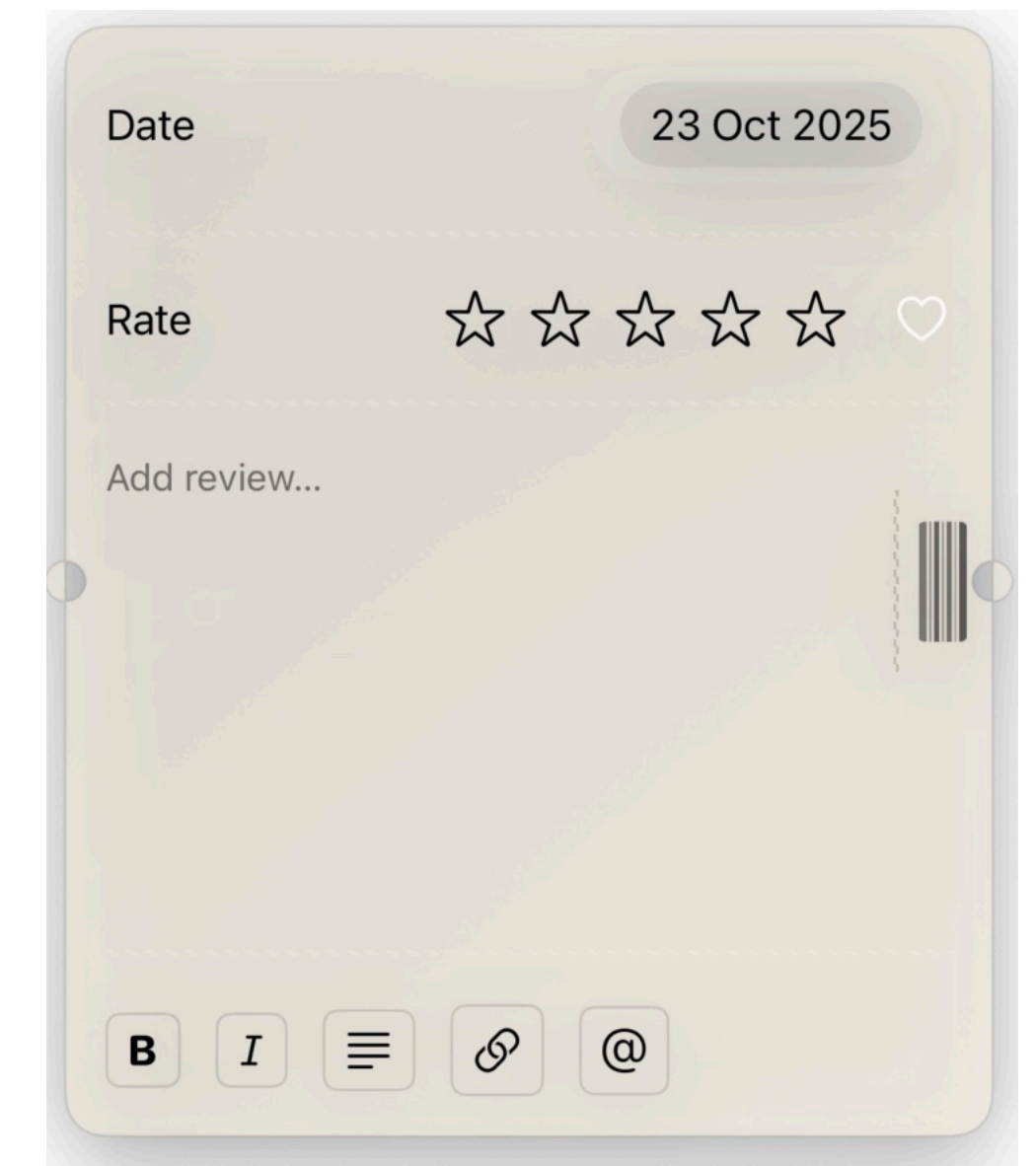
- SF Pro for system clarity; Abril Display for film titles — pairing contemporary digital and classic print.

Texture & Light:

- Soft grain overlay (opacity 0.1) across background layers.
- Shadows calibrated for cinematic contrast (Y: 3, Blur: 8).
- Micro-light bloom on icons when tapped — evokes projector flicker.

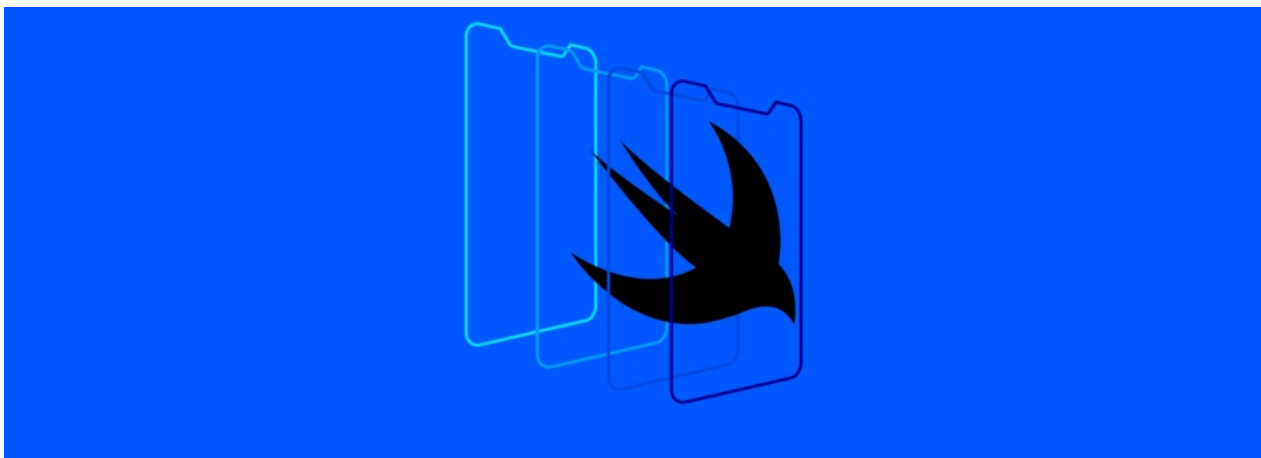
Motion Philosophy:

- Every motion has emotional purpose — nothing gratuitous.
- Animation timing mirrors cinematic pacing: slow open, decisive close.
- Collective motion consistency across modules ensures the prototype feels directed, not animated.



Develop

A Tactile, Cinematic UX System Built in Swift



Each screen was designed as part of a single, cinematic system — where tactility, rhythm, and restraint guide every interaction.

Create Event / Invites

- Liquid-glass popup replaces full-screen modal for focus and calm.
- Sequential reveal + flip-card ticket animation creates authorship and delight.

Upcoming Events & Film Clubs

- Stacked invite cards with 3D flip motion unify social and personal planning.
- Progressive disclosure simplifies flow for casual users while preserving depth.

Cinema Map & Booking

- Custom Letterboxd pins + modal venue cards connect digital and physical space.
- Circular-reveal booking, Apple Pay, and Wallet pass simulate cinematic purchase closure.

Diary & Reflection

- Half-height modal with “Publish Later” toggle enables low-stakes, authentic reflection.
- Warm duotone shift marks transition from private to public.

Event Tokens & Pack Nights

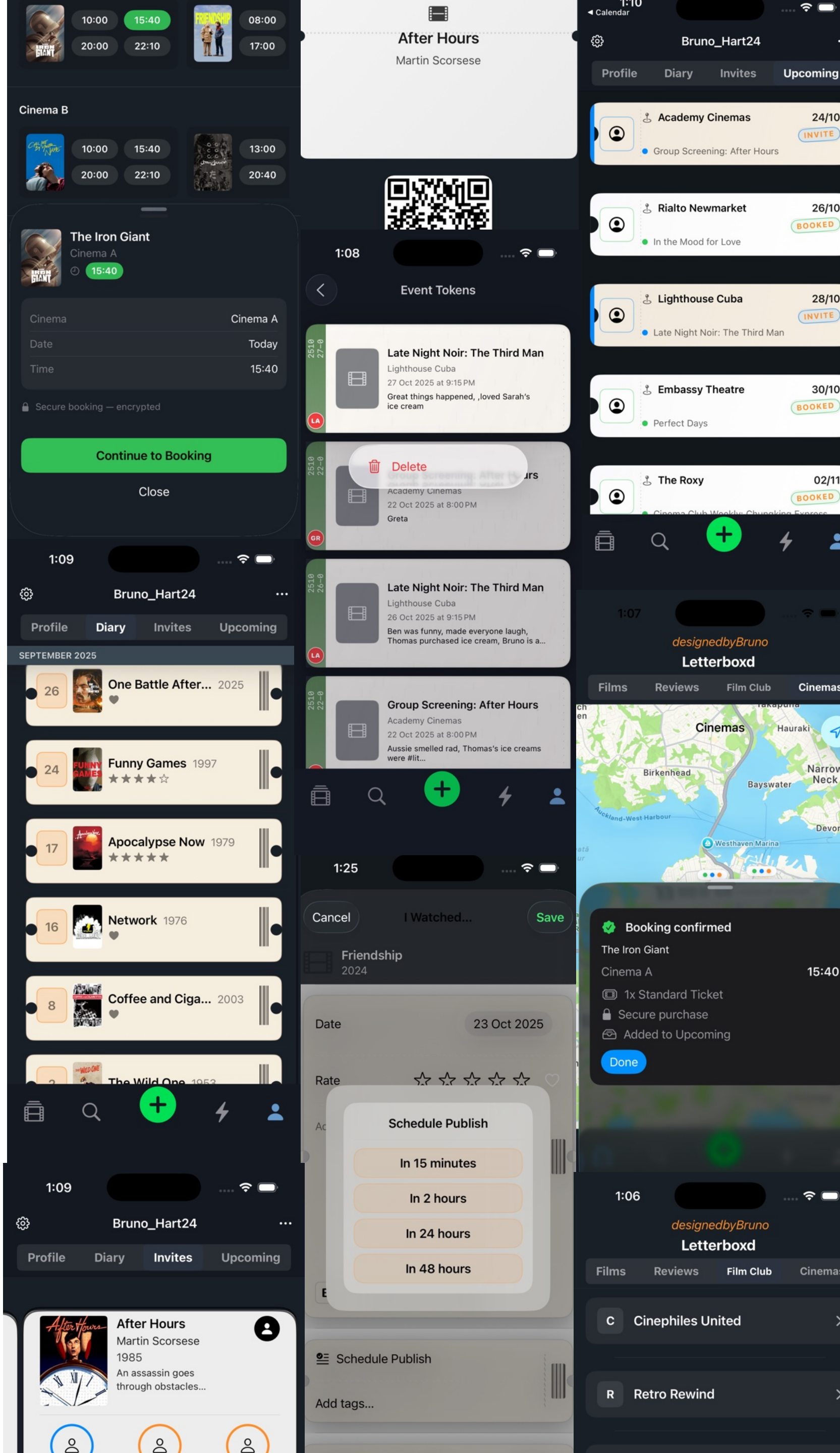
- Auto-generated collectible stubs provide physical-digital memory anchors.
- Optional atmospheric layer (light flicker, reel sound) transforms film nights into ritual.

System & Tone

- Duotone palette, grain, and soft motion express tactility without noise.
- Animations timed to cinematic pacing—calm, deliberate, human.

Outcome

A fully functional SwiftUI prototype where every detail serves a single purpose: to make Letterboxd feel alive at the heart of modern cinema.



Develop



Accessibility Through Code

Building the prototype in SwiftUI allowed accessibility to be designed into the system rather than layered on top. Because every interface element was coded natively, I could align motion, color, and hierarchy directly with Apple's Human Interface Guidelines and WCAG principles.

Key Accessibility Decisions:

- **Dynamic Type & Semantic Structure:**
 - All text uses SwiftUI's system fonts and semantic roles (.title, .body, .caption), automatically adapting to user text-size and contrast preferences.
- **VoiceOver Compatibility:**
 - Every control — from flipcards to booking buttons — includes descriptive accessibilityLabel and accessibilityHint, ensuring that animations remain perceivable through narration.
- **Reduced Motion:**
 - Animation logic respects system preferences (.accessibilityReduceMotion). Instead of removing effects, the prototype switches to fade transitions, preserving clarity without inducing motion fatigue.
- **Color & Contrast:**
 - The duotone palette was tested in both dark and high-contrast modes, maintaining legibility for low-vision users without sacrificing the cinematic tone.
- **Touch Targets & Gestures:**
 - All tap areas exceed Apple's 44x44pt minimum, and gestures such as flicks and flips have haptic feedback to confirm action through feel, not just sight.

By coding every detail in SwiftUI, I ensured the design wasn't just beautiful — it's universally usable.

Accessibility became part of the cinematic experience: clear, tactile, and inclusive by default.

```
20 }
21 }
22 }
23
24 struct TMDBMovie: Identifiable, Hashable {
25     let id: Int
26     let title: String
27     let year: String
28     let posterPath: String?
29     let backdropPath: String?
30 }
31
32 struct Person: Identifiable, Hashable { let id = UUID(); let name: String }
33 struct LBList: Identifiable, Hashable { let id = UUID(); let name: String }
34
35 // Per-mode form state so Create Invite and Create Club stay separate
36 struct FormState {
37     var selectedFilm: TMDBMovie? = nil
38     var selectedTheme: TicketTheme = .classicUS
39     var titleText: String = ""
40     var date: Date = Date()
41     var locationText: String = ""
42     var selectedPeople: Set<Person> = []
43     var selectedLists: Set<LBList> = []
44 }
45
46 let club: FilmClub
47
48 // State
49 @State private var mode: Mode = .invite
```

```
1 // MARK: - Create Event / Create Club
2 struct CreateEventView: View {
3     enum Mode: String, CaseIterable, Codable { case invite = "Create Invite", club = "Create Club" }
4     enum TicketTheme: String, CaseIterable, Identifiable {
5         case classicUS, japanese, european
6         var id: String { rawValue }
7         var displayName: String {
8             switch self {
9             case .classicUS: return "Classic American"
10             case .japanese: return "Japanese Graphic"
11             case .european: return "Elegant European"
12             }
13         }
14     }
15
16     struct TMDBMovie: Identifiable, Hashable {
17         let id: Int
18         let title: String
19         let year: String
20         let posterPath: String?
21         let backdropPath: String?
22     }
23
24     struct Person: Identifiable, Hashable { let id = UUID(); let name: String }
25     struct LBList: Identifiable, Hashable { let id = UUID(); let name: String }
26
27     // Per-mode form state so Create Invite and Create Club stay separate
28     struct FormState {
29         var selectedFilm: TMDBMovie? = nil
30         var selectedTheme: TicketTheme = .classicUS
31         var titleText: String = ""
32         var date: Date = Date()
33         var locationText: String = ""
34         var selectedPeople: Set<Person> = []
35         var selectedLists: Set<LBList> = []
36     }
37
38     let club: FilmClub
39
40     // State
41     @State private var mode: Mode = .invite
```

```
1 // ProfileTabView.swift
2 // ClaudeAndLetterboxd
3 // Created by Bruno on 16/10/2025.
4 //
5 //
6 //
7
8
9 import SwiftUI
10 import UIKit
11 import CoreMotion
12
13
14 struct ProfileTabView: View {
15     @ObservedObject var viewModel: ProfileViewModel
16
17     var body: some View {
18         VStack(alignment: .leading, spacing: 24) {
19             // Favorites Section
20             VStack(alignment: .leading, spacing: 12) {
21                 Text("FAVORITES")
22                 .font(.system(size: 13, weight: .medium))
23                 .foregroundColor(Color.lhHintText)
24                 .padding(.horizontal, 16)
25
26                 let columns = Array(repeating: GridItem(.flexible()), spacing: 12), count:
27
28                 LazyGrid(columns: columns, alignment: .leading, spacing: 12) {
29                     ForEach(0..<4) { _ in
30                         RoundedRectangle(cornerRadius: 8)
31                             .fill(Color.lhboard)
32                             .aspectRatio(2/3, contentMode: .fit)
33                     }
34                 }
35                 .frame(maxWidth: .infinity)
36                 .padding(.horizontal, 16)
37                 SectionDivider()
38                 .padding(.top, 12)
39                 .padding(.horizontal, 16)
40                 .padding(.top, 28)
41
42             // Recent Activity Section
43             VStack(alignment: .leading, spacing: 12) {
44                 Text("RECENT ACTIVITY")
45                 .font(.system(size: 13, weight: .medium))
46                 .foregroundColor(Color.lhHintText)
47                 .padding(.horizontal, 16)
48             }
49         }
50     }
51 }
```

```
1 // Notify other views (e.g., ProfileTabView)
2 NotificationCenter.default.post(name: .filmStatsChanged, object: nil)
```


Presentation ****Briefed**** overview of testing iterations and feedbacks

Refined Loop Summary

Cycle	Focus	Feedback Insight	Iteration	Result
1	Concept validation	Too complex for casual use	Simplified with progressive disclosure	Emotional clarity and calm
2	Ticketing flow	Booking felt essential, needed tactile closure	Refined tear animation + Wallet pass	Cinematic satisfaction
3	Pack Nights	Confusion on purpose	Reframed as sensory add-on	Emotional depth and delight
4	Final polish	Timing and tactility	Micro-motion tuning	Users described it as “a billion-dollar idea”

Develop

Reflections & Conclusions — Letterboxd *designedbyBruno*

This project began with a clear design challenge:

How might we restore the emotional and social ritual of cinema in a world defined by digital convenience?

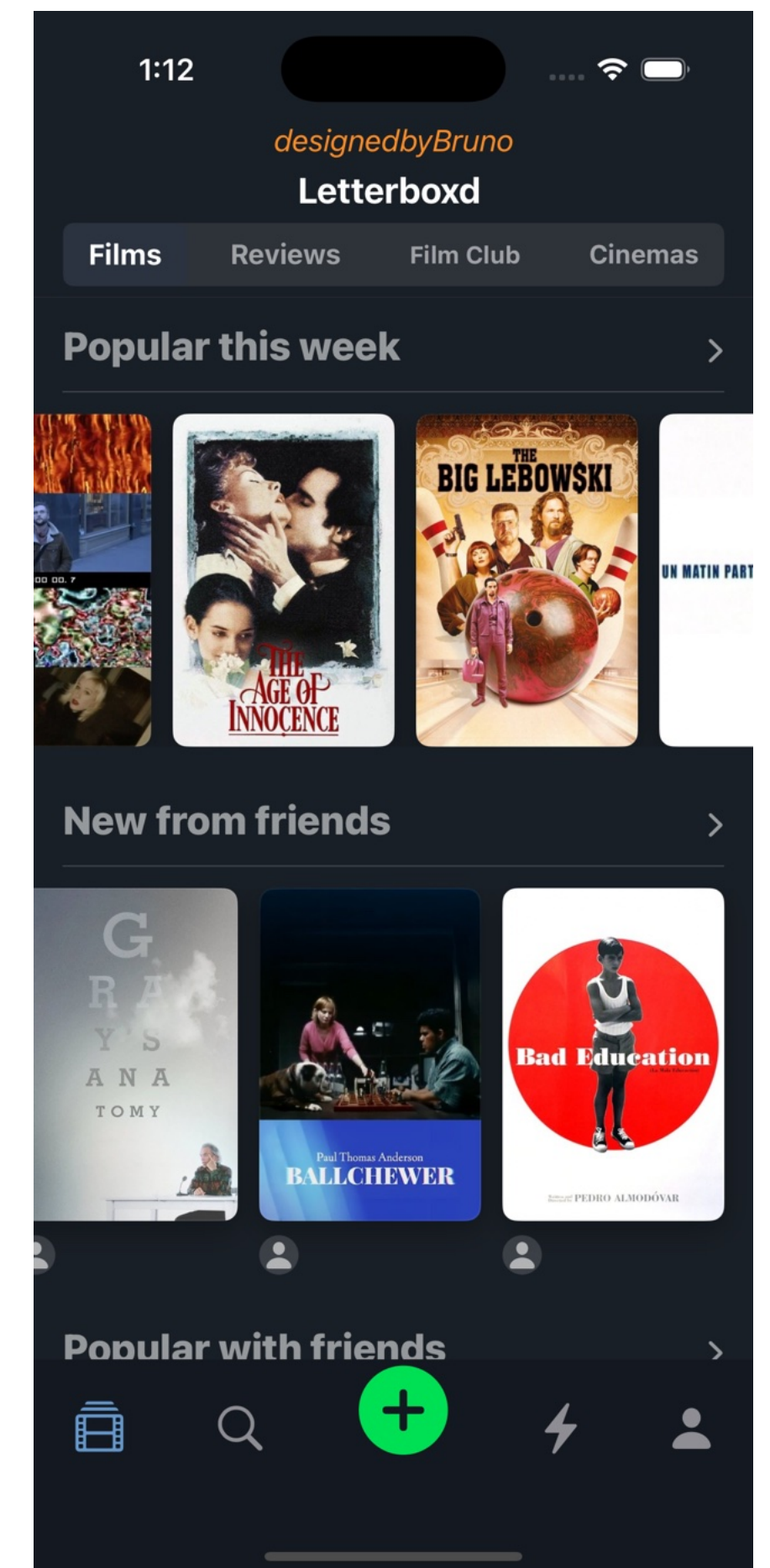
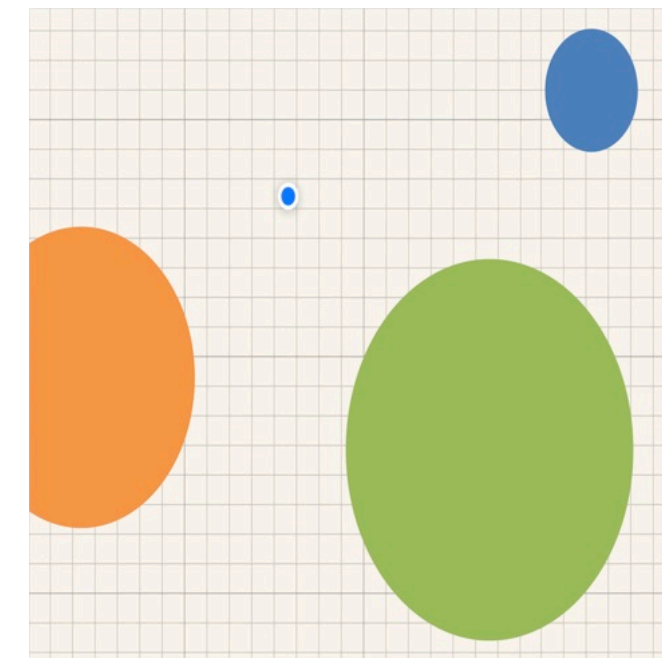
Through field research and behavioral mapping, I identified three **consistent human needs**: immediacy of reflection, tangible anchors for memory, and privacy before performance. These insights shaped every decision that followed.

Across **multiple iterations**, I approached the prototype as a system of human behaviors, materials, and timing—not as screens. Each layer of design and animation was tuned to express restraint, tactility, and cinematic rhythm. Every motion curve, texture, and delay serves a purpose: to make interaction feel calm, deliberate, and authored.

The success of this design lies in its clarity and integration.

Each feature—flipcard invites, publish-later diaries, collectible tokens—**directly addresses a verified user behavior**. Each module fits naturally into Letterboxd's existing ecosystem without redundancy or visual noise.

Technically, the prototype is end-to-end functional: built in SwiftUI with live TMDB, EventKit, and Wallet integrations. Conceptually, it transforms Letterboxd from a film-logging app into a ritual system for modern cinema culture.



Deliver

The success of my project centred on 2 core premises:

- 1) Do these feature increase your excitement and desire to use Letterboxd**
- 2) Do these feature increase your excitement and desire to experience events, in person with people (shared spaces)**

FEEDBACK → “F*CK YES”!!!!!!!



I am now going to give a live demo, giving you the opportunity to experience the craft, detail and precision of a fully programmed design

Please bare with me for the technical issues caused by our unfortunate circumstances